

# BetterTabs

for Unity Editor

*Official Documentation*

---

*A tabbed navigation system for the Unity Project panel*

---

Compatible with Unity 2021.3+ | Version 1.0

# Table of Contents

## 1. Introduction

## 2. Installation

- 2.1 Unity Package Manager (Git URL)
- 2.2 Unity Asset Store
- 2.3 Requirements

## 3. Getting Started

## 4. Adding Tabs

- 4.1 Drag and Drop
- 4.2 Using the + Button
- 4.3 Keyboard Shortcut

## 5. Closing & Restoring Tabs

- 5.1 Closing Tabs
- 5.2 Restoring Closed Tabs
- 5.3 Tab Context Menu

## 6. Navigating & Reordering Tabs

- 6.1 Switching Between Tabs
- 6.2 Reordering Tabs
- 6.3 Overflow Navigation

## 7. Browsing Content

- 7.1 View Modes
- 7.2 Search
- 7.3 Asset Context Menu

## 8. Asset Pinning

- 8.1 Creating an Asset Tab
- 8.2 Asset Tab View

## 9. Keyboard Shortcuts

## 10. Persistence

## 11. Support

# 1. Introduction

BetterTabs is a dockable Unity Editor window that enhances the built-in Project panel with a fully-featured tab management system. Instead of navigating back and forth through a monolithic folder hierarchy, BetterTabs lets you bookmark any folder or asset as a named tab and switch between them instantly — preserving the exact state of each tab across Unity Editor sessions.

Whether you are working on a large project with hundreds of folders or a small game with a handful of key assets, BetterTabs keeps your most important locations one click away.

## Key Benefits

- Navigate between project locations in a single click, without losing your place.
- Pin any asset — script, material, prefab, scene, texture, and more — as a dedicated tab.
- Full keyboard shortcut support for mouse-free workflows.
- Session persistence: your tabs and their state survive every editor restart.
- Seamlessly integrates with the standard Unity Project panel context menus.

---

## 2. Installation

BetterTabs can be installed via two methods. Both methods result in an identical package; choose whichever fits your workflow.

### 2.1. Unity Package Manager (Git URL)

This method always installs the latest published version directly from the repository.

1. Open **Edit > Project Settings > Package Manager** and make sure Git dependencies are enabled.
2. Open the **Package Manager** window (`Window > Package Manager`).
3. Click the **+ ▾** button in the top-left corner and select **Add package from git URL....**
4. Enter the following URL and press **Add**:  
`https://github.com/panchuel/bettertabs-unity.git`
5. Unity will resolve and import the package automatically. No further setup is required.

### 2.2. Unity Asset Store

1. Purchase or acquire BetterTabs from the **Unity Asset Store**.
2. Open the **Package Manager** window and navigate to **My Assets**.
3. Locate BetterTabs in the list and click **Download**, then **Import**.

## 2.3. Requirements

- Unity 2021.3 or later
- No additional packages or dependencies required

**i** *BetterTabs uses only official Unity Editor APIs and is compatible with all render pipelines (Built-in, URP, HDRP).*

---

## 3. Getting Started

After installation, open the BetterTabs window from the Unity menu bar:

```
Window > BetterTabs > Open BetterTabs
```

The window is fully dockable. You can drag it by its tab and snap it anywhere in the Unity Editor layout — next to the Project panel, in the Inspector, or as a floating window.

Once the window is open, you are ready to start adding tabs. See Section 4 for the different methods available.

**i** *BetterTabs works alongside the standard Project panel — it does not replace it. You can keep both open simultaneously.*

---

## 4. Adding Tabs

There are three ways to add a tab in BetterTabs. Each method works for both folder tabs and asset tabs.

### 4.1. Drag and Drop

Drag any folder or asset from the Project panel and drop it directly onto the BetterTabs window. A new tab is created immediately and becomes the active tab.

### 4.2. Using the + Button

Select a folder or asset in the Project panel, then click the + button in the BetterTabs toolbar. A tab is created for the currently selected item.

**i** *If nothing is selected in the Project panel, the + button is disabled.*

---

### 4.3. Keyboard Shortcut

Press **Ctrl+T** while the Project panel is focused to instantly create a tab from the active selection. This is the fastest method for keyboard-driven workflows.

---

## 5. Closing & Restoring Tabs

### 5.1. Closing Tabs

Tabs can be closed in the following ways:

- Click the **x** button on the right side of any tab.
- Press **Ctrl+W** to close the currently active tab.
- Right-click a tab and select **Close** or **Close Others** from the context menu.

### 5.2. Restoring Closed Tabs

Press **Ctrl+Shift+T** to reopen the most recently closed tab. This action is **stackable**: pressing the shortcut multiple times restores tabs in reverse order of closing, up to the full history for the current session.

### 5.3. Tab Context Menu

Right-clicking on any tab opens a context menu with the following options:

| Command         | Description                                                               |
|-----------------|---------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Close           | Closes the tab you right-clicked on.                                      |
| Close Others    | Closes all tabs except the one you right-clicked on.                      |
| Open in Project | Reveals and selects the tab's target in the standard Unity Project panel. |

---

## 6. Navigating & Reordering Tabs

### 6.1. Switching Between Tabs

- Left-click any tab to make it active.
- Hold **Shift** and scroll the mouse wheel to cycle through tabs from left to right.

### 6.2. Reordering Tabs

- Drag any tab horizontally to a new position in the tab bar and release to drop it.

- Hold `Ctrl+Shift` and scroll the mouse wheel to move the active tab one position to the left or right.

## 6.3. Overflow Navigation

When the total width of all tabs exceeds the tab bar, scroll arrows (< and >) appear at the left and right ends of the bar. Click these arrows to scroll the tab bar and reveal hidden tabs.

# 7. Browsing Content

When a tab points to a folder, BetterTabs displays its contents in a dedicated content area below the tab bar. This section describes the tools available for exploring folder tabs.

## 7.1. View Modes

A toggle in the toolbar switches between two view modes:

- **List view** — Displays assets in a hierarchical tree. Folders can be expanded or collapsed. The expansion state of each folder is preserved per tab.
- **Grid view** — Displays assets as icon tiles. Double-clicking a folder in grid view opens that folder as a new tab.

## 7.2. Search

The toolbar contains a search field that filters the displayed assets in real time. The search uses debouncing to avoid unnecessary computation while you type, and matching results are highlighted for quick identification.

The last search query for each tab is preserved between editor sessions.

## 7.3. Asset Context Menu

Right-clicking any asset inside a folder tab opens a context menu with standard asset operations:

| Command            | Description                                                                                                       |
|--------------------|-------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Open               | Opens the asset with its default application or editor (e.g., opens a script in your IDE, a scene in the editor). |
| Show in Project    | Reveals and selects the asset in the standard Unity Project panel.                                                |
| Reveal in Explorer | Opens the file in the operating system file manager (Windows Explorer / macOS Finder).                            |
| Rename             | Enters inline rename mode for the asset.                                                                          |

| Command   | Description                                                                                  |
|-----------|----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Duplicate | Creates a copy of the asset in the same folder.                                              |
| Delete    | Permanently deletes the asset after confirmation.                                            |
| Copy Path | Copies the asset's project-relative path to the clipboard (e.g., Assets/Materials/Rock.mat). |

## 8. Asset Pinning

Any non-folder asset can be pinned as a dedicated tab. Asset tabs are useful for keeping frequently edited files — such as a main game manager script, a shared material, or a key prefab — permanently accessible regardless of which folder you are browsing.

### 8.1. Creating an Asset Tab

Pin any of the following asset types (and more) using the standard tab creation methods described in Section 4:

- C# scripts
- Materials and shaders
- Prefabs
- Scenes
- Textures and sprites
- Audio clips
- ScriptableObject assets
- Any other non-folder asset type supported by Unity

### 8.2. Asset Tab View

An asset tab displays a dedicated view containing:

- **Preview** — A rendered thumbnail generated by Unity's built-in preview system.
- **Asset name and type** — Displayed below the preview for at-a-glance identification.

Three action buttons are available in the asset tab view:

| Command            | Description                                                        |
|--------------------|--------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Open               | Opens the asset with its default editor.                           |
| Show in Project    | Selects and reveals the asset in the standard Unity Project panel. |
| Reveal in Explorer | Opens the containing folder in the OS file manager.                |

---

## 9. Keyboard Shortcuts

The table below provides a complete reference of all keyboard shortcuts available in BetterTabs.

| Shortcut                       | Action                                  | Category       |
|--------------------------------|-----------------------------------------|----------------|
| <code>Ctrl+T</code>            | Add tab from active Project selection   | Adding Tabs    |
| <code>Ctrl+W</code>            | Close the active tab                    | Closing Tabs   |
| <code>Ctrl+Shift+T</code>      | Reopen the last closed tab (stackable)  | Restoring Tabs |
| <code>Shift+Scroll</code>      | Cycle through tabs                      | Navigation     |
| <code>Ctrl+Shift+Scroll</code> | Move active tab one position left/right | Navigation     |

*i Shortcuts that involve the Project panel (such as `Ctrl+T`) require the Project panel to be focused before pressing the key combination.*

---

## 10. Persistence

BetterTabs automatically saves the following state between Unity Editor sessions:

- The full list of open tabs and their order
- The currently active tab
- The view mode (list or grid) for each tab
- The folder expansion state in list view for each tab
- The search query for each tab

No manual saving is required. State is restored automatically the next time you open the Unity project.

*i Persistence data is stored locally within your project's Library folder and is not committed to version control. Each team member maintains their own tab configuration.*

---

## 11. Support

If you encounter a bug, have a feature request, or need assistance, the following resources are available:

- **GitHub Issues:** <https://github.com/panchuel/bettertabs-unity/issues>
- **Unity Asset Store Reviews:** Leave a review on the Asset Store page to share feedback or report issues.

When reporting a bug, please include the following information to help reproduce the issue:

- Unity version and operating system
- BetterTabs version
- Steps to reproduce the issue
- Any relevant error messages from the Console window

**i** *BetterTabs is actively maintained. Compatibility updates for new Unity versions are released as needed.*